

DIGITAL LITERACY

PROJECT REPORT

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INTRODUCTION

Digital literacy has become an essential skill for students in the modern digital world. It involves the ability to use digital tools effectively, communicate responsibly online, and understand the risks associated with the internet.

Through this project, I explored different aspects of digital literacy such as creating professional digital profiles, understanding online communication etiquette, practicing coding platforms, and learning about cybercrime awareness. The project also helped me understand how digital platforms can support learning and collaboration among students.

By completing various tasks such as creating an infographic, building online profiles, solving coding challenges, and studying cybercrime prevention, I gained practical knowledge about responsible digital behavior. This project helped me realize the importance of using technology safely and professionally in both academic and professional environments.

TASK 1 — DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS INFOGRAPHIC

Overview

In Task 1, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic using the Canva design platform. The purpose of the infographic was to explain the concept of digital literacy and highlight its importance for students.

What the Infographic Covered

The infographic was divided into clear sections so that students could quickly understand the key ideas:

- ◆ What Digital Literacy Means: A simple explanation of digital literacy and why it matters for students today.
- ◆ Useful Digital Tools: Platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, and Canva that students can use for learning and professional growth.
- ◆ Safe Internet Practices: Tips like using strong passwords, avoiding suspicious links, and protecting personal information online.
- ◆ Professional Online Presence: The importance of keeping professional profiles updated on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn.
- ◆ Email Etiquette: How to write formal emails with a clear subject line, polite greeting, professional language, and proper sign-off.

What I Learned

While creating the infographic, I learned how visual designs can present information in a simple and engaging way. One challenge I faced was organizing the information clearly so that viewers could easily understand the key points without feeling overwhelmed.

Overall, this activity helped me understand the importance of communicating digital literacy concepts through visual content. I also improved my skills in using Canva, including choosing colour combinations and arranging content in a neat layout.

TASK 2 — BUILDING MY DIGITAL PROFILES

Overview

In Task 2, I created and updated my digital presence on three professional platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms are widely used by students, developers, and professionals to showcase their skills and connect with others in their field.

GitHub

GitHub is a platform used by developers to host projects and collaborate on software development. I used GitHub to create a repository for my digital literacy project and to start building my technical portfolio. Having a GitHub profile allows recruiters and companies to see the actual work a student has done, even before they apply for a job.

LinkedIn

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform that allows students to connect with professionals and organizations. I updated my LinkedIn profile by adding my education details and academic information. A good LinkedIn profile acts like an online resume that employers can find and review.

Kaggle

Kaggle is a platform focused on data science learning and competitions where students can explore datasets and share code notebooks. Creating a Kaggle profile helped me explore another technical community and understand how students can use it to practice data science and machine learning.

My Plan for the Next Four Years

Over the next four years, I plan to actively use these platforms to grow both technically and professionally:

- ◆ GitHub: I will regularly upload my coding assignments and college projects to build a strong portfolio by the time I graduate.
- ◆ LinkedIn: I will keep updating my profile as I gain new skills and complete certifications, and I will connect with professionals in my field.
- ◆ Kaggle: I will practice data science problems, participate in beginner competitions, and use the free learning resources available on the platform.

TASK 3 — CODING PRACTICE AND COLLABORATION TOOLS

Overview

In Task 3, I explored online coding practice platforms and cloud-based collaboration tools. The goal of this task was to understand how these tools can help students improve their technical skills and work together in an online environment.

CodeChef — Coding Practice

I created an account on CodeChef and completed beginner-level practice problems to understand how coding platforms help students improve their programming skills. These platforms provide coding challenges that help learners develop logical thinking and problem-solving abilities, which are very important for any student in a computer science program.

Google Forms and Google Sheets — Collaboration Tools

I created a Google Form titled "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" to test students' knowledge about safe internet practices and digital literacy concepts. The form included five questions covering topics such as coding platforms, professional networking, and safe internet behavior.

I also connected the form responses to a Google Sheet so that the collected data could be viewed and analyzed easily. This helped me understand how cloud-based collaboration tools can be used for surveys, quizzes, and data collection in academic environments.

What I Learned

This task helped me understand that coding practice platforms and cloud tools are very useful for students. I learned how to use Google Forms for creating structured quizzes and how to link them with Google Sheets to manage responses efficiently.

TASK 4 — PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION AND DIGITAL ETIQUETTE

Overview

Task 4 focused on professional communication and digital etiquette. The goal was to understand how to communicate formally and responsibly in online environments, which is an important skill for both academic and professional life.

Writing Professional Emails

I wrote two professional email drafts as part of this task:

- ◆ Email 1: A request to a professor for an assignment deadline extension, written with a clear subject line, respectful greeting, proper explanation, and formal sign-off.
- ◆ Email 2: An email expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity, written in a professional tone with my academic background and reason for applying.

This activity helped me understand the importance of using proper subject lines, respectful greetings, and clear communication when writing formal emails.

Social Media Do's and Don'ts Checklist

I also created a checklist of social media do's and don'ts for students:

- ◆ Do: Protect personal information and keep profiles professional.
- ◆ Do: Think before posting — once something is online it is very hard to remove.
- ◆ Do: Use privacy settings to control who can see your content.
- ◆ Don't: Share passwords, OTPs, or sensitive personal details online.
- ◆ Don't: Click on suspicious links received through messages or emails.

- ◆ Don't: Post anything that could harm your reputation or others' feelings.

What I Learned

Through this task, I learned that digital communication should always be clear, respectful, and professional because it affects how others perceive us in both academic and professional environments.

TASK 5 — CYBERCRIME AWARENESS

Overview

In Task 5, I studied cybercrime awareness by analyzing a real-world case related to phishing attacks. This task helped me understand the different ways in which people can be targeted online and what steps can be taken to stay safe.

Case Study — Phishing Attacks

Phishing is a common type of cybercrime in which attackers send fake emails or messages that appear to come from trusted organizations such as banks or government offices in order to trick people into sharing personal information like passwords or bank details.

Through the case study, I learned how easily users can be misled by fraudulent messages that create a sense of urgency. For example, a message saying "Your account will be blocked in 24 hours — click here to verify" can push a person to act quickly without thinking, which is exactly what the attacker wants.

Stay Safe Online — Prevention Checklist

Based on what I studied, I created a prevention checklist with the following tips:

- ◆ Verify website links: Always check the URL before entering any personal information. Fake websites often have slightly different spellings.
- ◆ Use strong passwords: Create passwords with a mix of letters, numbers, and special characters. Avoid using the same password for multiple accounts.
- ◆ Enable two-factor authentication: This adds an extra layer of security so that even if someone gets your password they cannot log in without a second verification.
- ◆ Avoid suspicious emails: Do not click on links or download attachments from unknown senders.
- ◆ Never share OTPs: No genuine organization will ever ask for your one-time password over a call, message, or email.
- ◆ Be careful with payment requests: Always verify before making any online payment, especially if someone is asking for urgent transfers.

What I Learned

This task helped me understand the importance of cyber awareness and responsible behavior while using online platforms. Cybercrime is a real threat and knowing how to identify and avoid it is an essential digital skill for every student today.

CONCLUSION

This project helped me understand the true importance of digital literacy in modern education. Through the five tasks, I was able to experience and learn about many different areas of digital life — from designing infographics and building professional profiles, to writing formal emails, practicing coding, and studying cybercrime.

I learned that digital platforms can support learning, collaboration, and professional development when used in the right way. Each task gave me a new skill or a new way of thinking about how I use technology in my daily life.

The project also highlighted how important it is to communicate professionally and behave ethically in online environments. Something as simple as how you write an email or what you post on social media can have a big impact on how others see you as a student and as a future professional.

Overall, this project improved my awareness of digital tools and helped me become a more responsible and confident digital user. I plan to continue using the knowledge and skills I have gained here throughout my college journey and beyond.

— End of Report —